Downtime rule – Property: house, guild, stronghold · DM guide (table rules)

Between adventures, a group can **buy or build** a place: house, inn, guildhall, tower, stronghold, estate. These rules aren't in the SRD: they're **table rules** inspired by the Dungeon Master's Guide.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Buy**: cost in gp, time in days.
2. **Build**: cost depends on building type.
3. **Upkeep**: gp per day or month.
4. **Staff**: pay to keep the place running.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 no longer details construction; only general downtime rules exist.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say which building a group can afford. Fix: the DM sets a ceiling by level (see table).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the place as a character: its creaking door, its history, its neighbors.

Step 1 – Choose:

Type of place: house, guildhall, tower, stronghold, inn, estate.

Step 2 – Cost:

Construction or purchase price (see table).

Step 3 – Time:

Construction time in downtime days.

Step 4 – Staff:

A steward and guards are paid each month.

Step 5 – Benefits:

A place can earn (rents, goods) or protect (safe rest).

Example: the heroes buy a small tower (15,000 gp, 100 days). A steward keeps watch while they travel.

Building	Cost	Time
Guildhall (town)	5,000 gp	60 days
Small temple	5,000 gp	60 days
Trading post	5,000 gp	60 days
Outpost or fort	15,000 gp	100 days
Fortified tower	15,000 gp	100 days
Noble estate with manor	25,000 gp	150 days
Abbey, large temple, keep	50,000 gp	400 days
Palace or castle	500,000 gp	1,200 days

⚠ Common questions:

How much is a house?

By size: from a few hundred to several thousand gp.

How long does it take?

Per the table, 60 to 1,200 days.

Do I need staff?

Yes, for upkeep and security.

Does a place earn money?

Only with an activity (inn, farm).

Can a place be attacked?

Yes, it's an adventure site.

Can I sell it?

Yes, for half the price.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Fixed prices

Does the DM adjust? **Option**: yes by region.

Downtime

Can the group build mid-adventure? **Option**: no.

Income

Does an estate give gold? **Option**: 10% of cost per year.

Rent

Can I rent it out? **Option**: 1% of price per month.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Table rule

No SRD rule on constructing buildings.

Downtime

See the Downtime sheets.

Cost of living

See the Coins and Prices sheet.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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